THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

PARIS BRANCH

NEWSLETTER OCTOBER 2015

Chairman's Report

I bring you good news concerning the Comradeship Services Project which has caused much ink to flow since its launch at the tail-end of 2014. After the lobbying efforts by Paris Branch, and doubtless other overseas branches of the RBL, we have now heard that all Overseas Branches now have much more flexibility in being able handle subscription renewals locally.
The immediate result is that we shall be allowed to continue the practice, with only minor technical modifications, of having members pay their annual subscriptions and any donations, direct to their local Branch, and not to London as the Comradeship Services Project had required.
This is precisely what Paris Branch had advocated back in February 2015 when I was mandated by your Committee to write to the RBL National President and National Chairman.

This is indeed good news, not least because members resident in France will continue to benefit from a reduction on their income taxes paid in France in respect of subscriptions and donations to an association "d'interet publique".

This result was achieved at a high price in terms of the extra work and stress of keeping the lobbying campaign going during the holiday months of July and August. Your officers were under great stress in that period, and some family holidays doubtless suffered, including my own. So I take this opportunity to thank on your behalf Janet Warby, David Bean and Ian McDonald for all the effort they put into making our lobbying campaign function smoothly. I was aware of a very high quality of teamwork by your officers. They have served members interests well. Our warm thanks to them and their families.

At the same time I should like to thank here Branch member Robin Baker, who carried out for us very valuable research during our lobbying

on both the obligations of, and the protection provided by, the French Loi 1901 as applied to our Branch operating as a French association within an international Federation like the RBL. He was aided in this research by BCC Chairman Christopher Chantrey. We also wish to thank Christopher Crosthwaite for the very practical help also given to us in our 1901 Association context.

In this Newsletter you will find instructions from Membership Secretary Mark Yates on the payment of your subscription and donations for 2015-16.

Since our last Newsletter we have welcomed our new President d'honneur, Colonel Geoff Wright, the current British Military Attache. We should like to thank him for his whole-hearted support of our endeavours and our activities, and this has been much appreciated by your officers.

Business as usual from now on we hope, and already we are planning for our Commonweaith Service of Remembrance in Notre Dame de Paris on 11th November. Our pipers, Paris Branch member , Murdoch MacCleod, with his son Hector, will play for us again, as will trumpeter Tim Rarick who played for us last year with such panache. Rev Jim Cowie, our Chaplain, will read the Intercessions, and Rev Canon Alyson Lamb, Chaplain of St Michael's, will give the sermon.

Our AGM will now take place on Monday 30th November in the Clubhouse at the traditional time of 18.30. Please put that in your diaries and give us your moral support by attending.

"We will remember them"



Children and the Legion :

An urgent appeal to members

Your Paris branch has been invited into a number of schools in the Paris/Ile de France area to speak about our association, its work and poppies. As part of our schools Remembrance Project this year we have also received requests for veteran members to visit schools to answer questions from students about military service and memories.

If you have served in the forces at any time or have childhood wartime memories and would like to share your experiences with youngsters, talk about it for a few minutes or maybe just offer to answer questions we would very much appreciate your participation.

The following dates are already fixed.

- The British School of Paris, Juniors on Tuesday afternoon 13th October and Thursday afternoon 15th October.
- Lycée Rabelais in Meudon on Monday 2nd November,
- Lycée Descartes in Montigny les Bretonneux Friday 20th November

Janet Hadley can collect you and take you by car to and from the venue. Questions will be in English.

Alternatively, if you know anyone, not necessarily a Legion member, who might be interested in participating and whom we could approach, please don't hesitate to let us know.
If members, or friends, prefer not to visit schools, we are also looking at the possibilities such as a Skype interview at the Clubhouse and making written responses to questions sent in by students. We will be very grateful for any contributions, suggestions and assistance with this project from members and their contacts.

Please contact Janet (hadley.janet@gmail.com or by phone 06 24 59 74 31) if you are willing and able to participate, either on one of the above dates or in the future. We have already received much positive feedback about our project with schools. The experience is sure to be rewarding for all.



POPPY APPEAL COFFEE MORNING 2015

LADY RICKETTS, wife of H.M. Ambassador to France

Has kindly accepted to host a Coffee Morning

In aid of the Poppy Appeal

Which the ROYAL BRITISH LEGION, PARIS BRANCH

Organizes every year for the benefit of the

EARL HAIG BENEVOLENT FUND

The Coffee Morning will take place at

THE BRITISH AMBASSADOR'S RESIDENCE

39 rue du Faubourg St. Honoré,

Paris 8eme

TUESDAY, 3rd NOVEMBER 2015

10h30 - 12h00

Please send your stamped addressed envelope to :

Mrs Janet Warby
5 Allée des Pins,
78480 Verneuil sur Seine
01 39 28 90 28 or roger.warby@wanadoo.fr
PLEASE PRINT YOUR NAMES IN CAPITAL LETTERS

An invitation card for presentation at the entrance will be sent to you. This is a Charity event, please give generously. All donations welcome. I.D. Cards or Passports required. Numbers are limited. Date limit for applications 28/10/2015

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PARIS BRANCH

REPLY SLIP FOR LUNCHES
OCTOBER – DECEMBER 2015

I _____

Would like to reserve _____ place(s)

- For lunch on Thursday 15th October*
- For lunch on Thursday 19th November*
- For Special Christmas lunch on Friday 18th December**

*Please tick the lunch you wish to attend

I enclose one cheque for each of the dates I have indicated above, made payable to *l'Amicale des Veterans Britanniques* (We have now separated social events from RBL funds in line with RBL policy). The cost of each lunch is €17.00 which includes three course lunch plus apero, wine and tea or coffee.

**The Christmas lunch cost will be €30 per person

I enclose my cheque for €_____

I understand that I must give 3 days notice if I have to cancel to recoup my cheque otherwise I will be charged for the lunch I say I intend to attend.

Signed _____

Dated _____

Please send your replies to : Edouard Plunkett, Domaine de Montjay, 77720 Saint-Méry, edouard.plunkett@massoury.fr or 06 43 45 46 43

Dear Members,

If you have read this far, congratulations on your decision to support the endeavours of our Chairman and committee to ensure that the needs of RBL members abroad are respected. This in the face of a positive storm of revolutionary changes which, although they may have certain advantages in the UK, tend to ride roughshod over the requirements of those of us who have to work in a different cultural and legal climate.

The armed forces - after all our primary concern - have long ago learned the importance of respecting national differences when operating abroad. An early lesson, historians will quickly point out, was Auckland's Folly in the First Anglo-Afghan War nearly 200 years ago. The RBL management might yet learn from it. The subtlety of its initial approach to negotiations was nearer that of Ghengis Khan than that of Kissinger.

However we have managed to ensure that you can still pay your subscription, your gifts to the Poppy Appeal and the Administrative fund directly to the Paris Branch. Consequently, a consideration which concerns many of you, a *"récépissé fiscal"* will still be issued if requested and can be used for tax purposes in France.

As you will see on the form which follows, there is now a single membership fee, €41. This is between the two rates we have previously applied and, on average, is pretty much the same as last year.

We would remind you that only paid-up members can vote in the AGM which is likely to be particularly interesting this year so please do try to get your cheque in the post as soon as possible.

Remember, even if you can't get to the meeting you can vote by proxy, giving your vote to the Officer or member of your choice. If you are not in the Paris area, you may like to specify this when sending your subscription.

Best regards

Mark Yates

Membership secretary

Chers membres,

Si vous avez lu jusqu'ici, je vous félicite d'avoir décidé de soutenir votre président et votre comité dans leurs efforts pour s'assurer que les besoins des membres de la RBL à l'étranger soient respectés. Effectivement, on a eu du mal à faire comprendre à la direction que des changements qui pourraient présenter certains avantages à l'intérieur de la Royaume-Uni puissent nuire à ceux d'entre nous qui travaillent dans un climat culturel et une juridiction différents.

Les forces armées britanniques – qui restent, bien sûr, notre principale préoccupation - ont appris l'importance de tenir compte des différences nationales lorsqu'on travaille à l'étranger, et ce depuis longtemps. Notamment - et les historiens l'auront déjà pensé - depuis 'La Folie d'Auckland' pendant la première guerre en Afghanistan vers 1840. –

Les gestionnaires de la RBL d'aujourd'hui pourraient encore profiter de cette leçon. Il faut avouer que la subtilité de leur approche initiale lors des négociations ressemblait davantage à celle de Gengis Khan que celle de Kissinger.

Cependant, nous avons réussi à faire en sorte que vous puissiez toujours adresser votre cotisation, vos dons au Poppy Appeal et au fonds administratif directement à la RBL Paris. Ainsi, et c'est une considération qui préoccupe beaucoup d'entre vous, un « récépissé fiscal » valable en France sera toujours délivré sur demande et vous n'aurez pas à vous occuper des complications et des charges associées aux transferts d'argent vers l'étranger et dans une autre devise que l'euro.

Comme indiqué sur le formulaire sur la page suivante, nous appliquons maintenant une cotisation unique de 41€. Cette somme se situe entre les deux taux utilisés jusqu'alors. La moyenne n'a guère changé depuis l'an dernier.

Nous vous rappelons que seuls les membres ayant réglé leur cotisation peuvent voter à l'AGA. Celle-ci risque d'être particulièrement intéressante cette année. Ainsi il conviendrait de mettre votre chèque à la poste dès que possible.

Rappelez-vous que, même si vous ne pouvez pas assister à l'AGA, un vote par procuration est toujours possible. Vous pouvez le confier à un membre de la comité ou à tout autre membre de l'association. N'hésitez pas, si cette option vous intéresse, de le signaler lors de l'envoi de votre cotisation.

Cordialement

Mark Yates

Membership secretary

The Royal British Legion Paris Branch

Poppy Appeal & Subscriptions 2015-16 (payable 1° Oct 2014)

Poppy Appeal et Cotisations 2015-16 (dues 1° oct 2014)

Annual subscription
Cotisation annuelle €41

Poppy Appeal contribution
Don au "Poppy Appeal" .....

Administrative Fund donation
Don aux fonds administratifs .....

TOTAL .....

Name / Nom.....

Address / Adresse .....

……

e-mail ……..

Please underline if new or changed – veuillez souligner s'il est nouveau ou si vous l'avez modifié.

Please tick the box below if you require a fiscal receipt and, if so,
a stamped addressed envelope would be appreciated.

Veuillez cocher la case si vous désirer un récépissé fiscal et, dans ce cas,
joindre une enveloppe timbrée à votre attention si possible.

☐

Please make your cheque payable to the "Royal British Legion".
Veuillez établir votre cheque à l'ordre de "Royal British Legion"

Royal British Legion. 28 rue des Acacias 75017 PARIS . Tel 01 47 42 19 26
Website : **http://www.rblfrance.org/** e-mail : **mfyates@gmail.com**